

Technology Board Report - April 2026

Director of Technology – Steven Hopper

April has been extremely productive for the DCG Tech Department. In the previous update I mentioned three product evaluations currently underway. Our RFP for Chromebooks is currently open, and we continue to receive demo devices from all major brands: Dell, Acer, Asus, HP, CTL, and Lenovo. Proposals are due Friday, May 8, and we expect to have a recommendation to the board on May 18th. I've also been connecting with other tech directors about their device evaluations and bid results, and while prices have definitely risen, I'm confident we will find a solid option for our students.

We've also concluded our evaluation of new web filtering tools and the MacBook Neo. At this time, we've decided to continue with GoGuardian for web filtering. Our staff is very familiar with this tool, and the potential cost savings was minimal when compared to the amount of time, energy, and PD required to transition platforms. The capability of filtering software is also rapidly evolving, so instead of a multi-year agreement, we are only purchasing 1-year licenses with the intent to re-evaluate next spring. Similarly, while we think the MacBook Neo may be a great option in some cases (e.g. high school art, student teachers), we're going to push any decisions for large scale investments until next fiscal year.

Lastly, you'll see an action item to announce a public hearing on May 18th. In order to maintain eligibility for E-Rate funds, the district must demonstrate compliance with the Children's Internet Protection Act (CIPA). One of the requirements of CIPA is that the district must hold at least one public hearing to accept comment on the district's Internet Safety Plan. Our intent is to utilize Board Policies 605.06 (Internet and Digital Device - Appropriate Use by Students) and 713 (Responsible Technology Use & Social Networking) for this purpose. I will be present to address any questions, and the minutes of the meeting will be retained to demonstrate compliance with our CIPA obligations.

Congratulations to Dr. Carenza and the Academic Services Team on another successful year of ISASP. We had close to zero tickets related to online testing, which is a testament to their preparation and training. I appreciated his frequent communication on this topic.